

March 13, 2026 • Vol. 7, Issue 307 • \$5.99

Making sense of the world



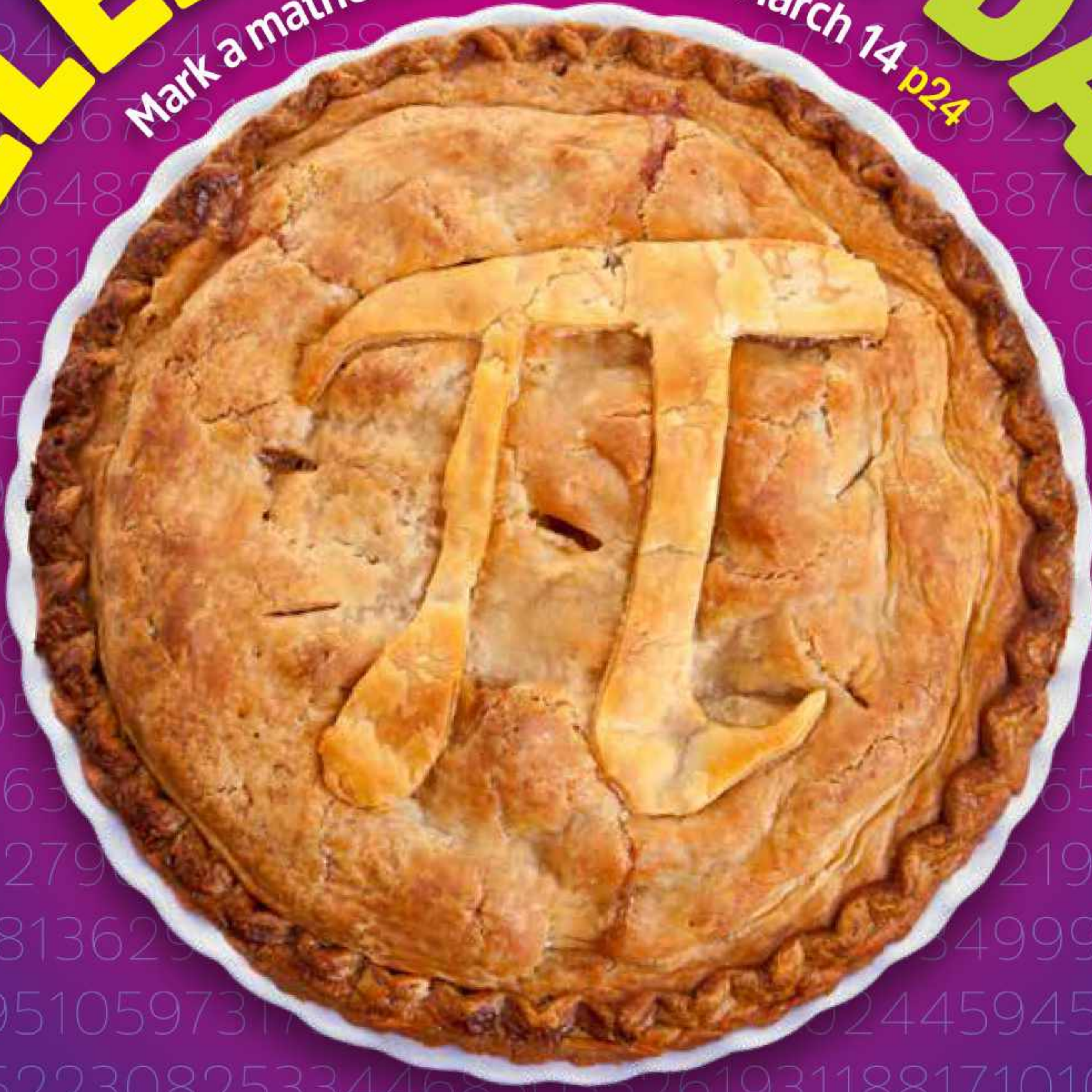
THE WEEK

Junior

THE BEST
MAGAZINE FOR
CURIOUS
KIDS

CELEBRATE PI DAY!

Mark a mathematical holiday on March 14 p24





DID YOU KNOW?

The earliest known written history of Iran, which was formerly called Persia, dates back to about 550 BCE.



Tehran on March 1

Iran fact file



- **POPULATION:** 87.3 million
- **SIZE:** 629,674 square miles
- **OFFICIAL LANGUAGE:** Farsi
- **OFFICIAL RELIGION:** Islam
- **LOCATION:** Bordered by Gulf of Oman, Persian Gulf, Caspian Sea, Afghanistan, Armenia, Azerbaijan, Iraq, Pakistan, Turkmenistan, and Turkey
- **GEOGRAPHY:** Desert terrain and tall mountains

Fighting widens in Middle East

Early in the morning on February 28, the US and Israel launched an attack on Iran. The fighting triggered widespread conflict in the Middle East.

What happened?

Missile attacks coordinated by the US and Israel struck the capital city of Tehran and other locations around Iran. The mission targeted military facilities and the compound of Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, the nation's supreme leader for nearly 37 years. Khamenei, age 86, was killed, as were dozens of high-level government and military leaders. Iran's naval headquarters and nine ships were destroyed. At least 800 people were killed in the strikes and fighting that followed. About 20 American service members were injured, and six were killed.

Why did this happen?

The White House said the attacks on Iran were necessary to prevent the country from obtaining powerful nuclear weapons, destroy its stockpile of long-range missiles, weaken its military, and stop it from supporting terrorism (use of violence to reach political goals). Last June, the US destroyed Iran's nuclear facilities, but in recent weeks, President Donald Trump accused Iran of rebuilding them. Iran denied this, and the two countries were

in discussions about the situation until two days before the attacks. Trump also criticized Iran's dictatorship (government that rules with total power). Khamenei, who came to his position in 1989, tightly controlled the country, banning criticism of his government and restricting Iranians' personal freedoms. In January, Iranians held massive protests against the government, which responded by killing thousands of demonstrators. After the latest attacks began, Trump urged the Iranian people to "take over your government."

How did Iran respond?

Iran denounced the attacks as "unprovoked, illegal, and illegitimate." The country and its allies quickly struck back at Israel and at US military facilities in neighboring countries, including the United Arab Emirates, Bahrain, Kuwait, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, and Cyprus, as well as at ships in a nearby shipping channel. The reaction to the death

of Khamenei was divided. Many people in Iran celebrated in the streets, while Iranians living in other countries, including the US, also expressed relief that his rule had ended. However, thousands of people gathered in Iran to mourn him and condemned the US and Israel for killing him.



A map of the region

How did other nations respond?

The United Nations Security Council held an emergency session on February 28. UN head António Guterres condemned the strikes, saying that the US and Israel violated international law prohibiting countries from attacking another unless they face an immediate threat. He and other world leaders called for peace and for the protection of civilians. Leaders in Spain expressed concern that the conflict would destabilize the region, the UK said it would not join the offensive, and Germany backed the US. In the US, most Republican elected officials supported the attacks. Others, including most Democrats, said Trump violated the US Constitution by not getting approval from Congress to use military force. Protesters also rallied against the attacks at the White House and in other locations across the US.

What will happen next?

On March 2, Trump said that the conflict was expected to last "four or five weeks" but the US is prepared to fight longer if necessary. When *The Week Junior* went to press on March 4, fighting was spreading and the US told Americans in the region to leave. Democrats in Congress said they would try to stop Trump from further military action in Iran without Congressional approval. A council will run Iran until a new supreme leader is chosen.



Festival of colors is celebrated

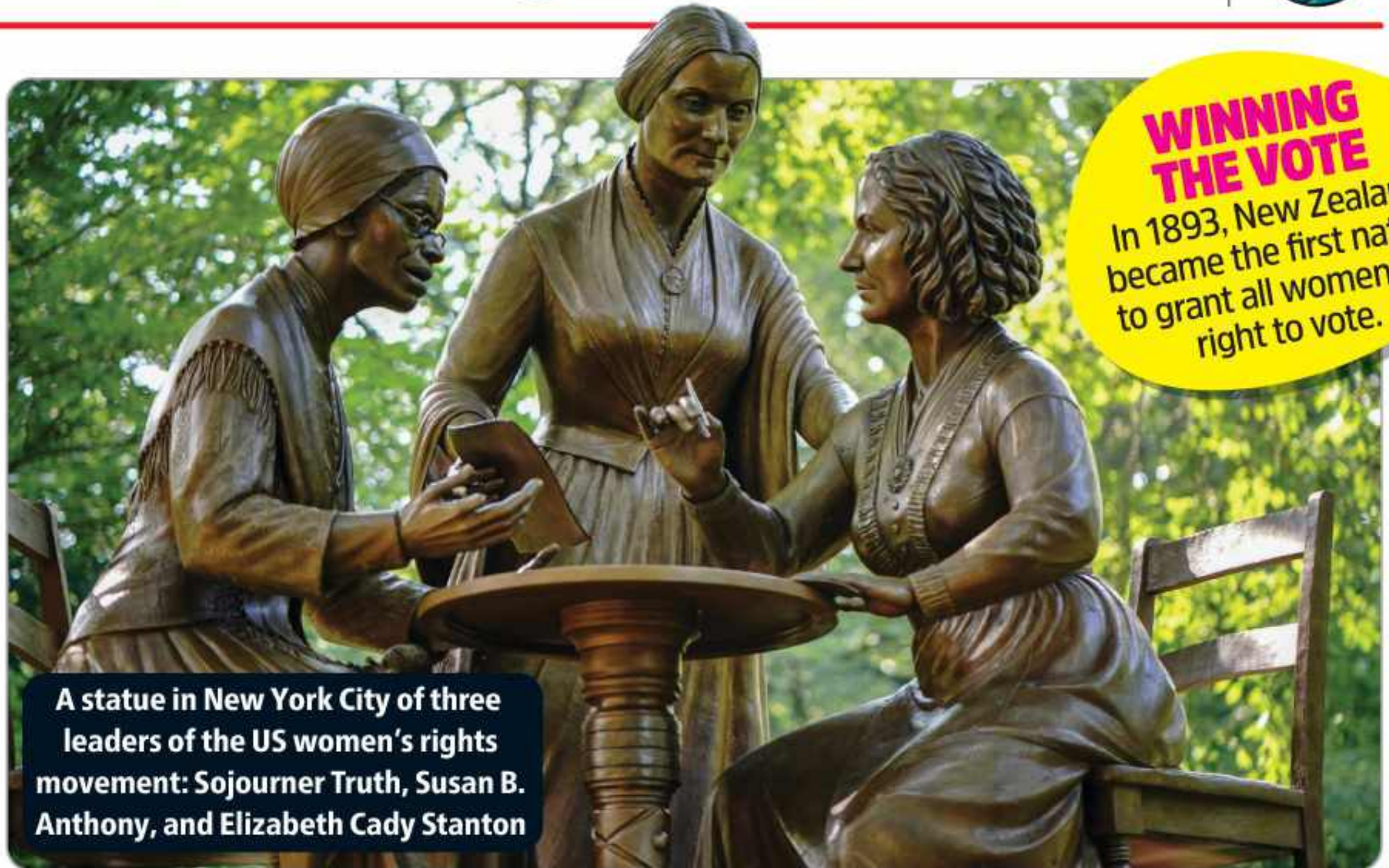
Millions of people in India and around the world celebrated Holi (pronounced HOE-lee) on March 3 and 4. Called the festival of colors, Holi marks the end of winter and the start of spring for people who follow the Hindu religion and signifies the triumph of good over evil and light over dark.

Holi has been celebrated for centuries. In many parts of India, festivities begin with a bonfire. On the day of Holi, people throw water balloons and toss brightly colored powder at each other. Traditionally, the powders were made using natural materials, like turmeric and marigold for yellow and indigo for blue. Today, synthetic or environmentally friendly dyes are commonly used.

Celebrations also take place in many other countries, including Nepal, Australia, South Africa, Mauritius, Uganda, Singapore, Mexico, the UK, and the US. Tens of thousands of people are expected at the Holi celebration in Spanish Fork, Utah, which is one of the largest outside India. It will feature traditional color throws, live music, dance performances, and yoga.



A Holi event



A statue in New York City of three leaders of the US women's rights movement: Sojourner Truth, Susan B. Anthony, and Elizabeth Cady Stanton

WINNING THE VOTE

In 1893, New Zealand became the first nation to grant all women the right to vote.

A time to honor women's history

This month, people around the globe will honor women's achievements, raise awareness about gender inequality, and inspire activism to support women. International Women's Day (IWD) takes place on March 8, and National Women's History Month in the US runs through the end of March.

IWD began in 1911 in Europe, where more than a million people rallied to improve women's working conditions and fight for their right to vote. The United Nations (UN) officially recognized the day in 1977. This year, with the theme "Rights. Justice. Action. For ALL Women and Girls," IWD focuses on laws to protect women.

The UN will be hosting speakers, panel discussions, and other events at its headquarters in New York City from March 9–19. In Florence, Italy, women will have free admission to museums

on March 8. In Croatia, celebrations will include a climb to the summit of St. Ilija on Sniježnica Mountain. A celebratory 6-kilometer run will take place on Andaman Island in Malaysia.

Women's History Month has its origins in Women's History Week, which started in California in 1978 and was made official by President Jimmy Carter in 1980. Congress passed a law in 1987 expanding the week into Women's History Month.

This year, the Smithsonian American Women's History Museum is hosting events, including a spotlight on women involved in space exploration. The National Hockey League's Pittsburgh Penguins will host a "Her Hockey Day" on March 22. The city of Pasadena, California, will host Amelia Earhart's Paper Plane Race and a discussion on how to achieve equal pay for women.



IT'S AN AMAZING WEEK FOR...

A MASSIVE COLLECTION

A woman in Australia set a record for the most Shopkins toys, with 2,656 different tiny collectibles in the shape of food, pets, and household goods. Alexa Szerstuk got her first one in 2014, at age 7. "It's pretty cool," she said of her world record.



Alexa Szerstuk

The winner



THE VERY BEST BAGUETTE

French baker Sithamparappillai Jegatheepan won first place in an annual contest to name the best baguette in Paris. The bread, a vital part of French culture, was assessed on appearance, flavor, and airiness. "Dreams come true," said Jegatheepan, who is originally from Sri Lanka.

A SPECIAL HORSE

A mare in Virginia named Fancy has been recognized as the world's oldest horse. Fancy, who will turn 38 on April 1, and her owner, Paige Blumer, have been together for 25 years. After competing with Blumer in many equestrian events, Fancy is retired. "Her loyalty never wavers," Blumer said of Fancy. "She has taught me so many life lessons."



Fancy



National news

NOTABLE BREAKFAST

On July 21, 1969, after Neil Armstrong and Buzz Aldrin landed on the Moon, they enjoyed peaches, bacon, and coffee on the lunar surface.



Kennedy Space Center in Cape Canaveral, Florida

Rare Moon observed



A rare total lunar eclipse occurred on March 3 (see above). Lunar eclipses happen when the Earth moves between the Sun and the Moon, shielding the Moon from the Sun. A total lunar eclipse is also called a blood Moon because small amounts of sunlight streak past Earth, turning the Moon's surface a dark shade of red.

Changes to Artemis mission announced

NASA, the US space agency, has announced plans to revamp its Artemis program. Artemis is a multipart mission to send humans to the surface of the Moon for the first time since 1972.

What happened?

The mission originally consisted of three parts: Artemis I, II, and III. In the new announcement, Jared Isaacman, the head of NASA, said that another Artemis mission will be added. Previously, Artemis III was intended to land astronauts on the Moon in 2028. Now, however, the goal of Artemis III will be to launch astronauts into Earth's orbit while trying to connect with a lunar landing system in 2027. The mission to land astronauts on the Moon will be the aim of Artemis IV in 2028. A second lunar landing, Artemis V, may also take

place in 2028, Isaacman said. The new plan was announced two days after the rocket that will be used in Artemis II was moved from the launchpad at Kennedy Space Center to its hangar for repairs.

Why did this happen?

More than three years have passed since Artemis I launched in 2022, and NASA is still working to launch Artemis II. The long wait between missions has limited NASA's ability to determine whether various problems have been successfully fixed, Isaacman said. The simpler Artemis III mission will allow scientists to test out docking processes and lunar landers before trying to land astronauts on the Moon. Previously, Artemis III was attempting too many unproven technologies for the first time, a NASA report found.

How did people react?

Amit Kshatriya, a NASA official, said the new plan puts the agency "on a more stable foundation" for the milestones ahead. James Muncy, an independent space policy consultant, called the revised plan "easier" and "less risky." NASA's partners also welcomed the updated timeline. SpaceX said it shares NASA's goal of returning to the Moon "as safely as possible."

What will happen next?

NASA is currently repairing the Artemis II rocket. Once that work is done, the mission—which consists of sending three US astronauts and one Canadian into space to circle the Moon for 10 days—will be cleared for launch. Officials said the rocket could lift off in early April.



WORD OF THE WEEK

CEREAL

The word "cereal" began to be used in ancient times, when Ceres was revered as the Roman goddess of agriculture and *cerealis* meant "belonging to Ceres." Ceres was responsible for nurturing and protecting food-giving plants, which is why food grains were given her name.

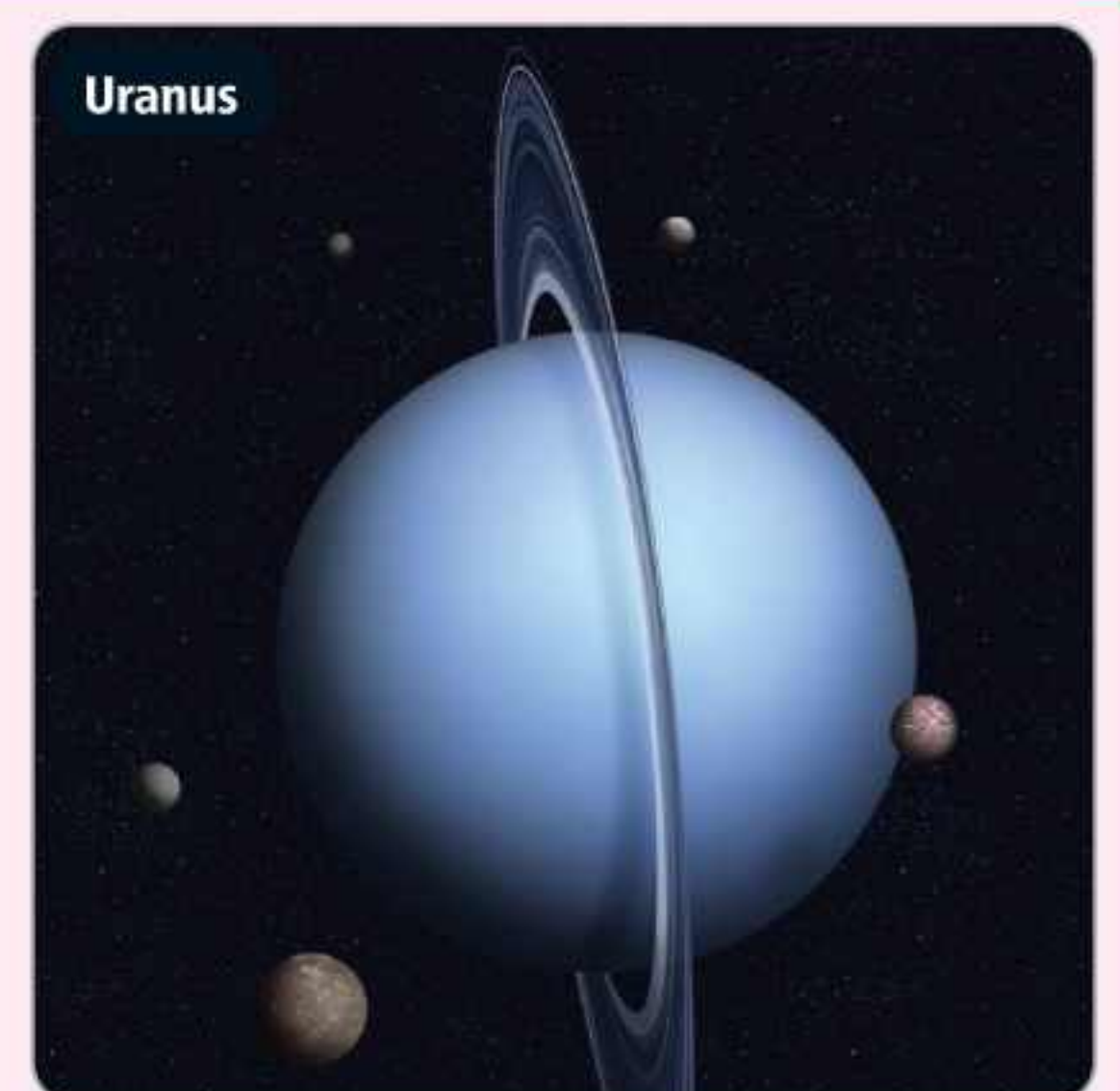


THE WEEK IN HISTORY

March 10, 1977

Rings of Uranus discovered

On March 10, 1977, five rings of the planet Uranus were spotted for the first time by US scientists, who were aboard NASA's Kuiper Airborne Observatory. They made the discovery in partnership with scientists at the Perth Observatory in Australia. Since then, at least 13 rings have been discovered around Uranus. Rings have also been discovered around the planets Jupiter and Neptune.





James Talarico

Two states hold first primaries

On March 3, primaries (elections) were held to determine who will run for the US Senate on Election Day, November 3. In Texas, James Talarico won the Democratic primary with 52.8% of the vote. None of the Republicans received 50% of the vote, which means the top finishers, John Comyn and Ken Paxton, will face each other in a runoff election in May. In North Carolina, Roy Cooper won the Democratic primary and Michael Whatley won the Republican primary.



Dolly Parton

Hospital named after music star

The East Tennessee Children's Hospital said it has changed its name to the Dolly Parton Children's Hospital. The name reflects the support Parton, a country music star, has given to pediatric care. While the hospital didn't share how much money Parton has donated, an executive said her generosity would ensure that "every child who walks through our doors receives the treatment they need."



Player Tara Rudd wearing the new jersey

New uniforms for soccer team

The Washington Spirit, the National Women's Soccer League team based in Washington, DC, unveiled new uniforms inspired by the city's cherry blossom trees. The "Spirit in Bloom" uniforms feature a white and pink floral pattern against the club's signature green. Since Japan gave more than 3,000 cherry blossom trees to the city in 1912, the trees have symbolized strength and resilience.



P!NK

WORK IN PROGRESS

Construction to expand Rock Hall by 50,000 square feet began in 2023, and the work is set to be completed this fall.

Billy Idol

New Edition

Lauryn Hill

Rock Hall nominees are chosen

The Rock and Roll Hall of Fame in Cleveland, Ohio, has named the nominees for its new class of inductees. The list includes 17 individuals and groups, including 10 first-time nominees.

Getting inducted into the Hall of Fame, known as Rock Hall, is one of the biggest honors in the world of music. It celebrates an artist's or group's entire career, recognizing their lasting influence on musical culture rather than the release of a single album or song. Founded in 1983, Rock Hall inducted its first class in 1986, which included music legends Chuck Berry and Elvis Presley.

Nominees are voted on by more than 1,200 music historians, industry professionals, and past inductees. To be eligible, artists must have released their first commercial recording at least 25 years ago. Some artists are nominated multiple times before being selected.

Among this year's first-time nominees is Lauryn Hill, a pioneering R&B and hip-hop musical

artist. Others include New Edition, one of the first modern boy bands; Wu-Tang Clan, which helped expand hip-hop worldwide; and Latin star Shakira, who is the first Colombian musical artist to receive a nomination. R&B legend Luther Vandross, who sold more than 40 million albums and died in 2005, is being nominated for the first time posthumously (after death).

Artists who are returning to the ballot after a previous nomination include Billy Idol, one of the first musicians to blend punk and rock. Pop star Mariah Carey, who has recorded 19 songs that hit number one on the music charts, is nominated for a third consecutive year. Singer and drummer Phil Collins, who was inducted into Rock Hall with his band Genesis in 2010, is now a first-time nominee as a solo artist.

The inductees will be announced in April, and a ceremony in their honor will take place later this year. All the nominees are listed at rockhall.com.



The Rock and Roll Hall of Fame

THE WEEK'S SILLIEST HEADLINE

"Escaped monkey wanders into Missouri homeowner's garage" UPI





Around the world



The city



Barcelona, Spain

Visitors face tourist tax increase

Barcelona is doubling its tourist tax and will soon charge visitors up to \$18 per night to stay in the city. By 2028, it also plans to ban all short-term vacation rentals, such as homes rented out to tourists through the company Airbnb. The city is facing a housing shortage, and authorities hope this will free up properties for local people to live in. Some hotel owners oppose the changes, fearing that higher taxes will drive tourists away.



Supplies are being sent.



Somalia

Funding for food and healthcare

The European Union (EU, a group of 27 nations) promised Somalia about \$74 million for food and lifesaving healthcare supplies. Millions of people in the country are struggling, partly because of fighting between Somalia's government and armed groups that oppose it. The area has also faced droughts (long periods without rain), which make it difficult to grow food. The EU said it will work with partners in Somalia to deliver aid.



After the storm



Minas Gerais, Brazil

Floods destroy buildings

On February 24, record rainfall in Brazil's Minas Gerais region caused floods and landslides. Buildings collapsed, and some houses were swept away when a river overflowed. At least 70 people died. Firefighters and volunteers rescued people trapped in their homes, and the government said it would provide new houses to people whose homes were destroyed.



Grindelwald, Switzerland

Snow sculpting contest held

At the World Snow Festival in Switzerland, artists from 10 countries carved figures from 10-foot-high blocks of snow. The team from Spain took first prize in the technical category, while a team of stonemasons from the UK won the public vote for sculpting a mythical sea monster, called a kraken, eating a boat.



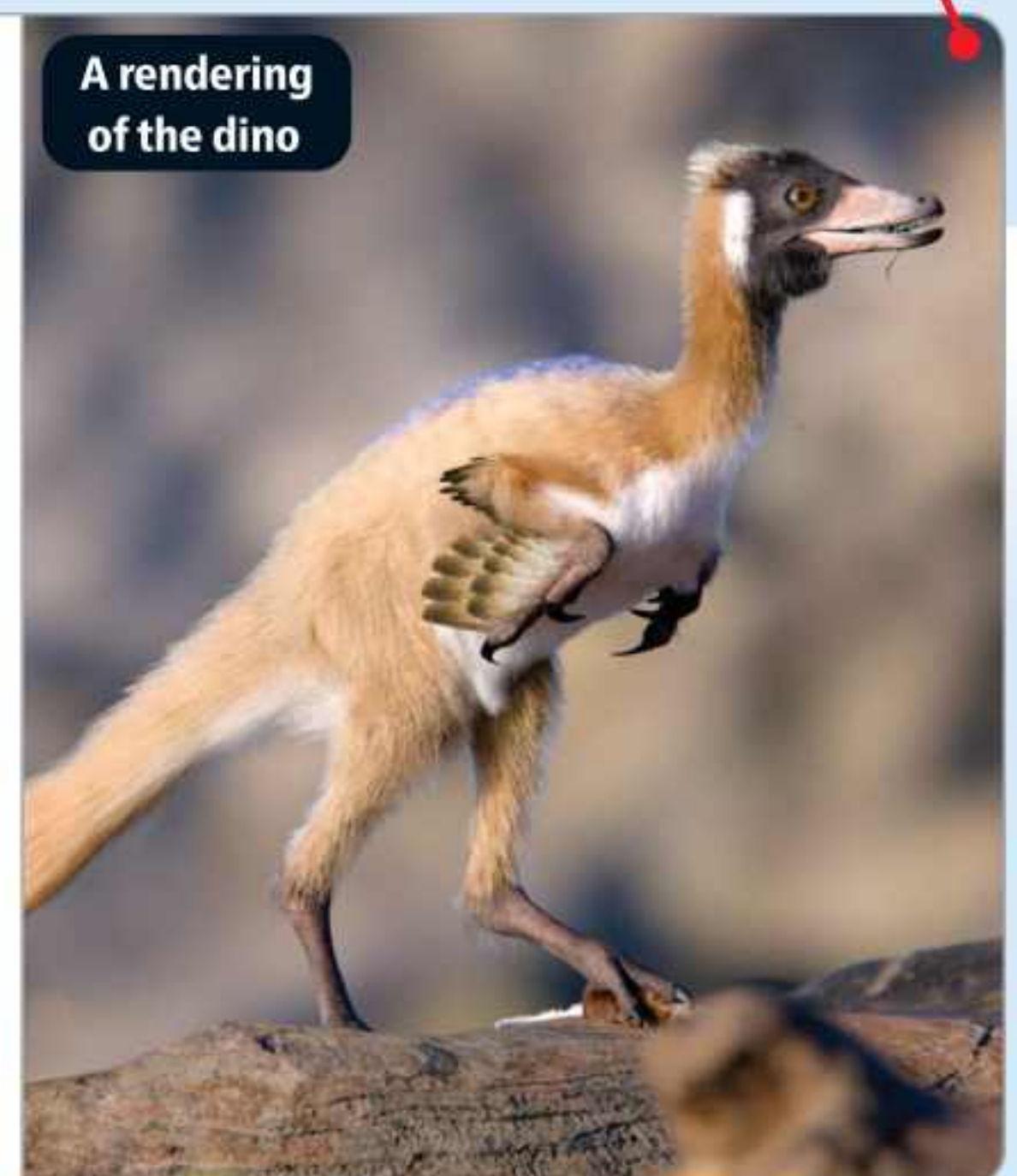
The kraken sculpture



Patagonia, Argentina

Tiny dinosaur discovered

A fossil of one of the world's smallest dinosaurs has been discovered in northern Patagonia. The dinosaur, named *Alnashetri cerropolicensis*, weighed 1.5 pounds and was about the size of a crow. The fossil, from a 4-year-old female nicknamed Alna, was well preserved by sand. Scientists think the dino had feathers but could not fly and probably hunted small animals like lizards and snakes.



A rendering of the dino

MICHAEL FLECKER/SCIENCE DIRECT (2); OSCAR OLIVARES/INSTAGRAM; GETTY IMAGES (5); GABRIEL DIAZ YANTEN, UNIVERSIDAD NACIONAL DE RIO NEGRO; WORLD SNOW FESTIVAL/TEAM GERMANY; SHUTTERSTOCK



Protesters

Milan, Italy **Protests against fur**

On March 1, animal rights activists gathered outside a show at Milan Fashion Week and called for organizers to ban fur. The use of animal fur in clothing has fallen in recent years, mainly due to concerns about animal cruelty. Protesters want the event, where fashion designers showcase their latest creations, to exclude brands that use fur.



Brigid Kosgei

Tokyo, Japan **New record at Tokyo Marathon**

Kenyan runner Brigid Kosgei set a new women's course record at the Tokyo Marathon, one of the world's major marathons, on March 1. She finished the 26.2-mile course in 2 hours, 14 minutes, 29 seconds. Ethiopian runner Tadesse Takele won the men's race for the second straight year, finishing in 2 hours, 3 minutes, 37 seconds. Swiss athletes Marcel Hug and Catherine Debrunner won the men's and women's wheelchair races.



People in Kerala

Keralam, India **State changes name**

The government is changing the name of an Indian state from Kerala to Keralam. The new official English spelling matches the way most locals say the name. In Malayalam, the main language spoken by the southern state's 35 million residents, *kera* means "coconut tree" and *alam* means "land." Keralam is one of many Indian states and cities that have changed their names since 1947, when India became independent from British rule.



A bowl from the shipwreck

Singapore **Rare porcelain found underwater**

Archaeologists studying a shipwreck off the coast of Singapore uncovered about 300 pounds of rare blue and white porcelain from the Yuan Dynasty (1279–1368). The ceramics featured imagery of mandarin ducks and mythical creatures such as dragons and phoenixes. The ship likely set sail from Quanzhou, China, and was heading to Temasek, in what is now Singapore.

San Salvador, El Salvador **Mural made of bottle caps**

The world's tallest recycled mural has been installed on a building in El Salvador's capital city. Artist Óscar Olivares created the nearly 43-foot-tall mural from more than 100,000 recycled plastic bottle caps. Inspired by Leonardo da Vinci's famous *Mona Lisa*, the design features a Salvadoran woman draped in the colors of the country's flag. Olivares said he wanted to raise awareness about plastic and create beauty from waste.



The mural



ANIMAL EMBRACE
Spider monkeys use their arms and tails to hug each other.

A Geoffroy's spider monkey

Monkeys share tips on finding food

Researchers have discovered that spider monkeys share information with one another about the best places to find food. The fruit-eating monkeys live in large social groups of up to 100 animals but usually search for food in smaller subgroups. After an expedition into the forest, individual monkeys often switch between subgroups to combine their knowledge, which gives everyone a better chance of obtaining a good meal.

Scientists studied the behavior of endangered spider monkeys in Mexico's Yucatán Peninsula for seven years. They followed a species called Geoffroy's spider monkeys, tracking where individual monkeys went and when they met up with other monkeys. The team then created a map based on the animals' knowledge of the forest and figured out where there were gaps, such as a fruit tree that some of the monkeys had never visited.

The researchers also analyzed the monkeys' subgroups and said these were formed for a purpose and not for "random social mingling."

Members were not determined by age or how recently they moved into the area. The team concluded that the animals constantly changed their subgroups so monkeys that knew different parts of the forest could share information about where fruit was available.

"Some parts of the forest are known by multiple monkeys, like a town's most popular restaurant, while others are known by only one or two monkeys, like a hidden gem," said researcher Matthew Silk. "It's a clever system for sharing insider knowledge about where the best fruit trees are."

Experts said the best scenario is when the monkeys explore different parts of the forest and then reconnect to share the information they have gained. For example, one monkey may know where the best fruit is, and another could tell when it is ready to eat. "This maximizes the whole group's collective coverage of the best feeding spots," Silk added. The team hopes to use the same research method to study other animals that hang out in changing groups.



Enjoying a meal

Whales teach each other a trick



Humpback whales in Canada have been using a novel hunting method called "bubble netting" (above). A group of whales will swim in circles while blowing air through their blowholes to create bubbles in the water. Herring and other prey get trapped in the ring of bubbles, making it easier for the whales to snatch them up.

Experts had previously seen this behavior in Alaskan whales and wondered how the Canadian whales had learned it. After mapping the humpbacks' interactions, they concluded that certain whales have been teaching the technique to others, possibly when they all go to Hawaii to breed. Sharing the strategy may be helping humpback whales survive.



TOPSY-TURVY

Upside-down jellies got their name from their habit of resting on the seafloor with their tentacles pointing up toward the sunlight.



Cassiopea andromeda

Sea jellies sleep like humans do

A new study has revealed that sea jellies have similar sleep patterns to humans. The animals, also known as jellyfish, sleep for about eight hours a night. They take short naps in the middle of the day and need more rest after a night of poor sleep.

The study was based on video recordings of an upside-down jellyfish called Cassiopea andromeda and a starlet sea anemone in a tank. Researchers exposed the animals to light for half the time to mimic shifts between night and day. During the “night,” the anemones stayed still for

long periods of time, and the jellies were less active and took longer to respond to the presence of food. The researchers took these as signs of sleep. Both animals slept in approximately eight-hour cycles.

The researchers also found that while both animals were awake, cells in their nervous system showed signs of damage—but the damage was reduced while they were sleeping. This suggests that animals, including humans, may have developed the need for sleep in order to keep their nervous systems healthy.

Animal of the week

Black-breasted puffleg



Conservationists are working to restore a forest in Ecuador that is a crucial habitat for black-breasted pufflegs. This rare species of hummingbird is named for the white feathers around its legs that look like puffy pants.

- **LIFESPAN:** 5 to 10 years
- **HABITAT:** Cloud forests in the Andes mountains
- **SIZE:** About 3.5 inches tall
- **DIET:** Insects and flower nectar
- **FUN FACT:** Hummingbirds can fly backward and upside down and can stop to hover in midair.



Good week / Bad week



Atlantic horseshoe crabs

This 445-million-year-old species is making a comeback at Cape Cod National Seashore in Massachusetts. Experts recently saw about 1,000 horseshoe crabs breeding in the East Harbor, a big rebound after their 150-year disappearance.



Forests

Scientists warn that forests around the world are losing the varied plant life that makes each one special. Tropical and subtropical forests are most vulnerable to threats such as climate change, and their native species are unlikely to return.



“Why do cats’ tongues feel like sandpaper?”

Brady, 11, Michigan

Jonathan Losos

Professor of biology,
Washington University in St. Louis

Cat tongues are covered with hundreds of tiny, stiff spines made of keratin, the material in our fingernails and hair. These spines work like sandpaper to scrape meat off bones. They are also critical for grooming. The hollow tip of the spine fills with saliva, which cleans the fur.



Do you have a question for an animal expert? Send it to hello@theweekjunior.com. Find out more about Washington University in St. Louis at washu.edu.



Cheerful spring blooms

For centuries, tulips have captivated admirers with their elegant beauty.

Tulips are vibrant flowers that come in dozens of shades, sizes, and patterns. Find out how they became one of the world's most popular blooms.



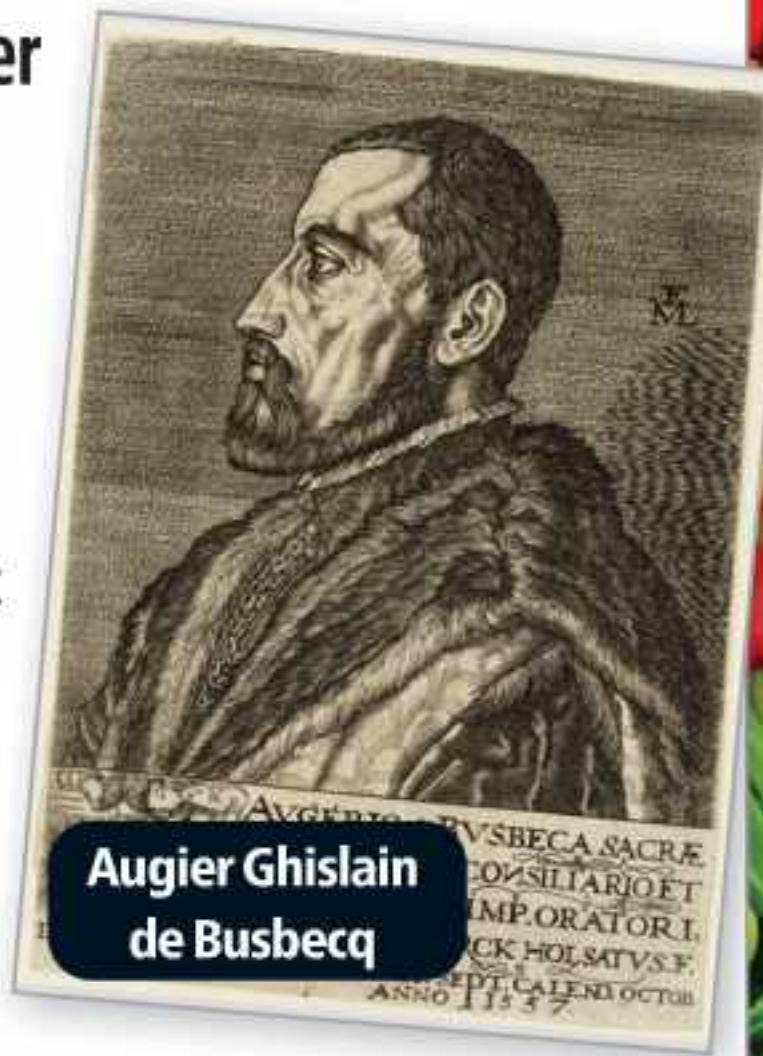
A wild tulip

What is a tulip?

Tulips announce the arrival of spring. They typically begin as bulbs planted in autumn, emerge from the ground in late winter, and bloom in the spring. There are about 100 species of tulips, which belong to the lily family. The two main types are wild tulips and commercially grown tulips. Wild tulips are small, typically ranging from 3 to 8 inches tall. They are often found on mountain slopes and may have pointy, star-shaped blooms. Cultivated flowers, on the other hand, can measure from 6 inches to 2 feet tall. Each tulip stem usually holds one flower, which is often shaped like a cup.

History of a flower

Tulips are native to Central Asia and Turkey, where they have survived for hundreds of years. They were likely first grown in the 10th century in Persia, in what is now Iran. The tulip later became a symbol of the Ottoman Empire (1299–1922), appearing on pottery, monuments, cannons, and other objects. In the 16th century, Augier Ghislain de Busbecq, the Viennese ambassador to Turkey, sent tulip bulbs home to Vienna, where they drew attention. The flowers soared in popularity in the Netherlands in the 1590s after a botanist (scientist who studies plants) began cultivating them at the University of Leiden. During this era, tulips were infected with a virus and bloomed in streaks of color. These stunning “broken” tulips helped fuel a growing tulip trade.



Augier Ghislain de Busbecq



TAKING ROOT

Tulips arrived in the American colonies with Dutch settlers in the mid-17th century.

The Netherlands is the world's leading exporter of tulips, with about 60,000 acres of land set aside to grow them.

Tulip festivals

The Netherlands is famous for its magnificent tulip displays. Here are a few festivals that celebrate tulips in other countries.



Turkey

The International Tulip Festival is held in Istanbul every spring. More than 20 million tulips bloom across the city's avenues, gardens, traffic roundabouts, and public spaces. A “tulip carpet” in vibrant patterns in Sultanahmet Square (left) is a popular gathering spot to admire the blooms.





in many colors

PRECIOUS PETALS

During "Tulip Mania" in the Netherlands in the 1630s, some bulbs were worth tens of thousands of dollars in today's money.



ROYAL BLOSSOMS

Tulips were once called the "flower of the kings."



A "broken" tulip

A rainbow of hues

Today, there are nearly 4,000 varieties of tulips in an array of colors, such as red, pink, purple, yellow, white, and brown. Rembrandt tulips mimic historic "broken" varieties, with blooms that have stripes and flames. Tulips in solid colors are typically called "self-colored." Cultivated tulips are categorized into 15 groups depending on their shape, their heritage, and when they blossom. Tulips that bloom in early spring include single early (blooms with a single layer of six petals in a cup shape) and double early (blooms with multiple layers of petals and a ruffled look similar to a peony). Darwin hybrids are mid-season bloomers and among the tallest tulips. Late-blooming tulips include single late, double late, lily-flowered, and parrot types. Tulips close at night, and are phototropic: They turn toward sunlight during the day.



A tulip museum

Prized flowers

Tulips are one of the most popular commercial flowers in the world and are cultivated for show and exhibition. The Amsterdam Tulip Museum, in the Netherlands, chronicles the journey of the tulip through history. Between March and May, more than 1 million people visit the Keukenhof Gardens, also in the Netherlands, to see vast displays of tulips. Every year, about 7 million bulbs in more than 1,600 varieties are planted there. At the same time, many wild tulips are critically endangered or vulnerable because of climate change and commercial growing. Researchers are calling for urgent attention to the flowers' plight.

Japan

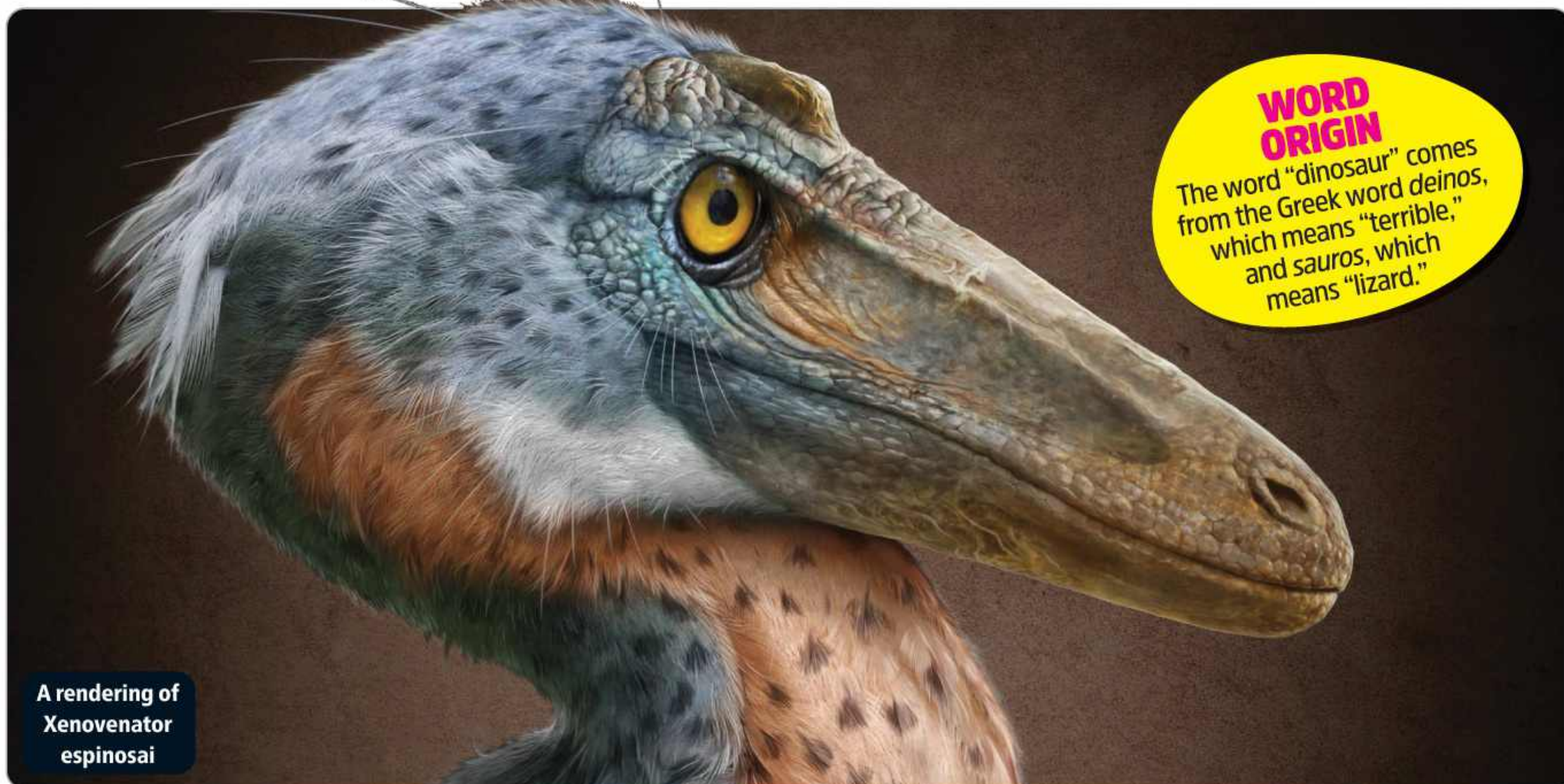
The city of Susono hosts the annual Heavenly Tulip Festival, which features more than 100,000 blooms. With a view of Mount Fuji in the distance (left), visitors can enjoy fields of flowers and an opportunity to try tulip-flavored soft-serve ice cream.



United States

The Skagit Valley Tulip Festival (left) in Washington state attracts visitors from around the world every April. Tens of millions of tulips are spread across multiple gardens on about 250 acres, making the annual event one of the largest tulip festivals in the US.





WORD ORIGIN

The word “dinosaur” comes from the Greek word *deinos*, which means “terrible,” and *sauros*, which means “lizard.”

A rendering of *Xenovenator espinosai*

Little dino liked to headbutt rivals

A newly identified dinosaur that lived about 73 million years ago likely took its opponents head-on. The birdlike dinosaur, which was found in Mexico, was named *Xenovenator espinosai* (“strange hunter”).

Xenovenator espinosai’s braincase (part of the skull containing the brain) was sticking out of the ground when paleontologists (scientists who study the past through fossils) were surveying the Cerro del Pueblo formation in northeastern Mexico in 2000. They found three specimens, but only one had an almost intact braincase. The area is known for yielding rich dinosaur fossils.

The team of scientists determined that the braincase belonged to a troodontid. This group of dinosaurs likely walked on two legs and hunted their prey. Troodontids are known to have some of the largest brains relative to their body size.

When researchers scanned the raptor’s brain, they found that it had a thick domed head, which was different from the thin skulls of other troodontids. Its skull also had a bump in the front, and its bones were interlocked in a zigzag pattern. In some spots, the braincase was about half an inch thick and spongy inside.

The team doesn’t think this feature would have been useful to the creature when it hunted. Instead, they think the bird could have used its skull to headbutt its rivals when competing for mates. They cited other extinct and modern animals that have similar features and ram their heads, including other dinosaurs, giraffes, bighorn sheep, and musk oxen. A modern bird called the helmeted hornbill, which smashes heads with its rivals midair, has tissue in its skull to absorb the shock that is similar to the *Xenovenator*’s spongy interior.

Xenovenator espinosai lived in the Late Cretaceous period, a competitive time for dinosaurs because many of them existed but there were few resources to go around.

Many animals of the time evolved to have features that helped them survive, like horns and crests. The researchers believe *Xenovenator espinosai* may have done the same, in the form of its thick skull.

“Dinosaurs at the end of the Cretaceous were not just evolving new ways to eat or move but new ways to interact with one another,” Héctor Rivera-Sylva, the lead author of the paper, told *The New York Times*.



A *Xenovenator espinosai* fossil

A chicken-sized dino



Scientists have discovered a new plant-eating dinosaur species that lived in what is now Spain about 130 million years ago. Named *Foskeia pelendinum* (shown in a rendering, above), the creature measured a little over a foot tall, making it one of the smallest known ornithopods (dinosaurs that stood on two legs). One of the most well-known ornithopods is the *Iguanodon*, which grew up to 30 feet in length.

Although *Foskeia pelendinum* is an ornithopod, it was not just a mini *Iguanodon*, according to the new study. Despite its small size, it had an advanced skull, and its teeth indicated that it had the ability to chew from the back of its mouth instead of the front. The small birdlike creature could help scientists better understand how ornithopods evolved.



Photos of the week



Test the water

This picture of a horse and rider in Turkey was taken by Doğa Ergün.



Team effort

Ayden Feagle took this photo during a soccer match in Florida.



JEIRIN ANTON; AYDEN FEAGLE; VICTOR REICHERT; ABDALLAH ISLAM; DOĞA ERGÜN; RILEY SHICKLE



Stunning sight

In Japan, autumn leaves frame Mount Fuji in a shot captured by Riley Shickle.



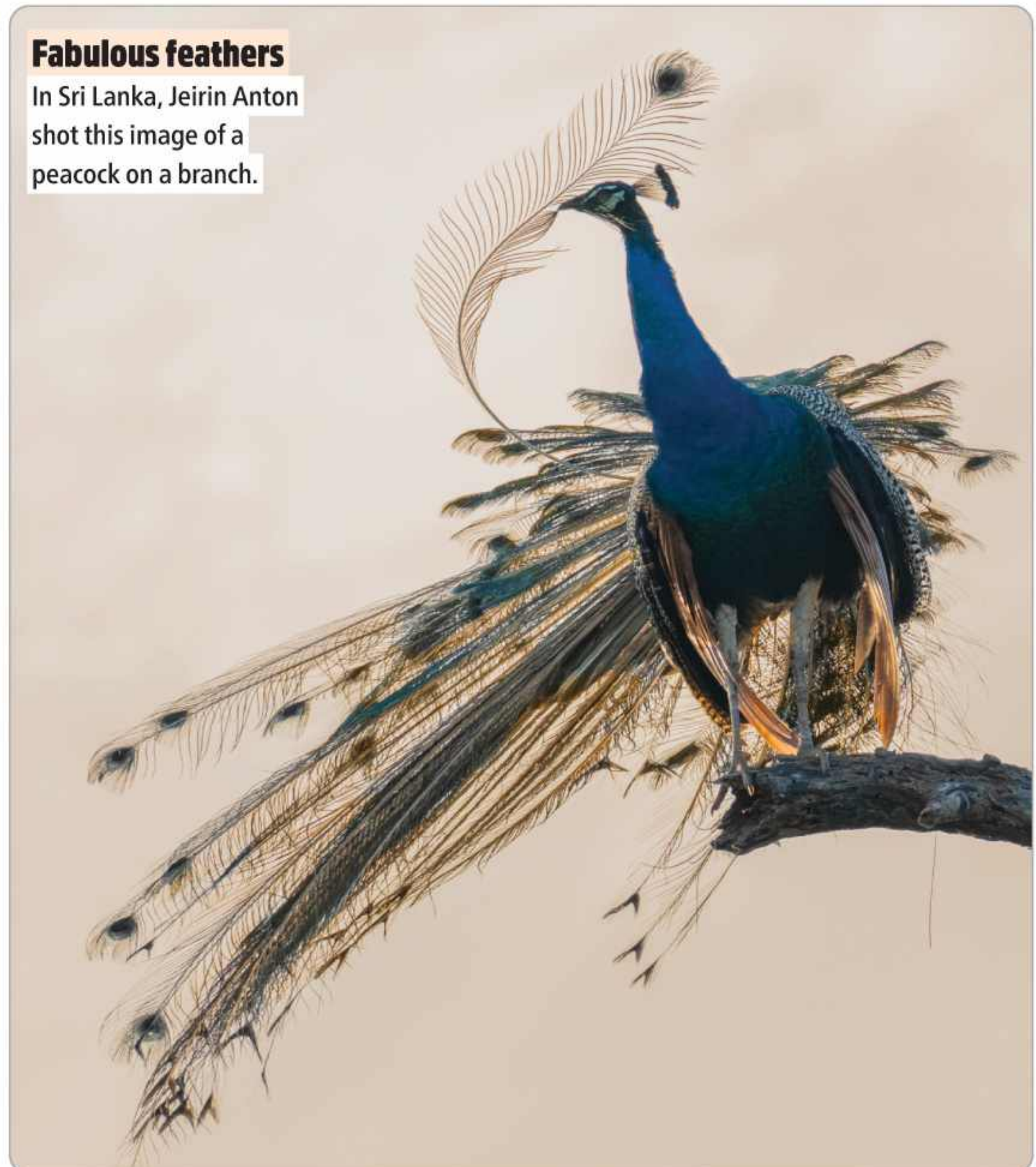
Taking shape

Abdallah Islam photographed the Great Pyramid in Egypt behind a sculpture.



Group bonding

Victor Reichert snapped this picture of a family of monkeys in Sri Lanka.



Fabulous feathers

In Sri Lanka, Jeirin Anton shot this image of a peacock on a branch.



BIG DAY

Cavan Sullivan—age 16 and a midfielder for the Philadelphia Union—scored his first pro soccer goals during a Concacaf Champions Cup match on February 26.



Inter Miami star
Lionel Messi

US women compete



The SheBelieves Cup, a women's soccer tournament featuring national teams from the US, Canada, Colombia, and Argentina, began on March 1. The US, which has won the Cup seven times, beat Argentina, 2–0, in their first match. The event ends March 7.

New MLS season gets underway

This year's MLS (Major League Soccer) season began on February 21. It is the 31st season for the league, which has 30 teams across the US and Canada. Inter Miami CF, led by global superstar Lionel Messi, are the defending champions. They are aiming to become the first team to win back-to-back MLS titles since the 2011 and 2012 seasons.

This year, the MLS schedule will pause from May 25 to July 16 due to the FIFA World Cup, which begins on June 11. It is one of the most important tournaments in international soccer, and although national team rosters have not been set yet, many MLS players are expected to play for their home countries.

The first MLS weekend featured a full slate of matches. One of the most anticipated contests took place in Los Angeles, California, as LAFC hosted Inter Miami. During the offseason, Inter Miami strengthened its roster in hopes of remaining at the top of the league, but LAFC delivered a strong performance and won, 3–0. On February 28, LAFC had another dominant defensive showing in a 2–0 win over Houston Dynamo FC.



Thomas Müller

The Vancouver Whitecaps FC, last year's MLS Cup runners-up, also got their season off to a good start. They opened with a 1–0 victory over Real Salt Lake, then followed that up with a 3–0 win over Toronto FC a week

later. Thomas Müller, a German soccer star who joined the Whitecaps in August, scored two of the goals in the second match.

In Florida on March 1, Orlando City SC hosted Inter Miami in a highly anticipated matchup between the rival clubs. Orlando reached the playoffs in each of the past six seasons, which is the longest active postseason streak in the league. The team appeared to be on their way to a comfortable win after scoring the first two goals of the contest, but Miami mounted an impressive comeback, scoring four second-half goals to win, 4–2. Messi scored twice.

After the first two matches of the season, five teams remained undefeated: Vancouver, LAFC, the New York Red Bulls, San Diego FC, and the San Jose Earthquakes.

THIS WEEK'S WINNERS...

AUTO RACING

In NASCAR action on March 1, Tyler Reddick won the Texas Grand Prix at the Circuit of the Americas in Austin, Texas. He had already won the Daytona 500 and Autotrader 400 this year, and with his latest victory, he became the first driver in NASCAR history to win the first three races of a NASCAR Cup Series season. He is in first place in the NASCAR Cup Series standings, followed by Bubba Wallace and Chase Elliott.



Tyler Reddick
and his son Beau

PRO BASKETBALL

On February 26, in a 133–109 win over the Indiana Pacers, Charlotte Hornets rookie Kon Knueppel hit his 207th three-point shot of the season, breaking the NBA record for most three-pointers in a season by a rookie.

COLLEGE BASKETBALL

The University of Connecticut women beat St. John's University, 85–49, on March 1 to end the regular season with a 31–0 record. It was their 47th straight win dating back to last season.



WOW!
The women's gold-medal hockey game at this year's Olympics had the most TV viewers of any women's hockey game in history.

Seattle Torrent
vs. Toronto
Sceptres

Exciting return to PWHL action

After shining at the Winter Olympics in Italy, many of the world's best women's hockey players are back in North America, where they have reunited with their college and PWHL (Professional Women's Hockey League) teams. The PWHL is in its third season, so it did not exist in any previous Olympic years. In a sign that viewers enjoyed the action in Italy, ticket sales for PWHL games have increased since the Olympics ended.

Sixty-one PWHL players from across all eight PWHL teams were part of eight national teams at the Winter Games. Before the league paused for an Olympics break, the Boston Fleet were at the top of the standings, followed by the Minnesota Frost, who are the two-time defending champions, and the Montreal Victoire. The regular season ends in April.

On February 26, in the first game back, the Victoire defeated the New York Sirens, 4–1. The next day, the Toronto Sceptres faced the Seattle Torrent. Seattle's captain is Team USA captain Hilary Knight, who is currently injured. Although the Torrent lost, 5–2, there was still reason to celebrate. The game was a sellout, with 17,335 fans in attendance—the largest crowd ever for a women's hockey game at a US arena.

The same day, the Fleet had a thrilling 3–2 win over the Ottawa Charge after a penalty shootout. The Fleet's roster includes two Team USA heroes: Megan Keller, who scored the gold medal-winning goal at the Olympics, and star goaltender Aerin Frankel. In the Charge game, Keller assisted on the Fleet's game-tying goal, while Frankel saved four of the Charge's five penalty shots in overtime.



COACH OF THE WEEK

Coach's Name: **Kristian Jackson**

Team: **Cobra Kai (basketball)**

"Coach Kristian is amazing and one of the best coaches out there. It's no surprise that I won three championships with him! He acts so funny at practices and helps our whole team get better. He always lifts us up when we feel sad or down. If I feel bad for missing a game-winner, he says next time we'll win the game. He is so encouraging and develops players on and off the court. I am grateful to him for being my coach." Jayen, 10, California



To nominate a Coach of the Week, send your coach's name, photo, sport, and team to hello@theweekjunior.com. Include your name, age, state, and a few reasons why your coach is great.

SPOTLIGHT ON...



Kotoko Blair

AGE: 21 SPORT: SWIMMING

TEAM: NORTHEASTERN UNIVERSITY

Jumping in My dad was a swimmer and wanted me to be one too. I've been in the pool since I was probably 6 months old. I started competing at about 7 years old. Around 10, I joined a USA club team. It was really hard. It took a couple of years for me to understand that it takes time to get fast and not to give up.

Pool passion I love feeling very free in the water and not being confined to gravity. I also love going fast—I'm a sprinter. Being able to jump off the blocks and go all out is exciting. The art of swimming itself is beautiful, too.



Workout plan Our season is six months long, and we train about 20 hours a week. About 80% of that is in the water. We'll use a lot of equipment, such as a pulley system where you're pulling against 60 pounds across the pool. The other 20% of training is dry land workouts and lifting weights. As a sprinter, I work on having explosiveness, strength, and speed all coming together into one motion.

Major role This year I became team captain. Being a leader while still competing is challenging. There are days when you're struggling, but you can't bring that energy into practice. The team deserves the best version of you in those two hours.

Wise words If you really want something, you can do it. People prove it every day. I got so much inspiration watching the Olympics. The Japanese pairs figure skating team were in fifth place, pulled out an incredible final performance, and got the gold—I'm half Japanese, so I take pride in that. There is nothing stopping you, except for yourself.



Book club

THIS WEEK'S BOOK

City Spies: Europa

By James Ponti

As a half-dozen young secret agents relocate to their new London headquarters, an old enemy strikes again. In the seventh installment of this popular series, the City Spies team intercepts a cryptic message from Umbra, a sinister crime organization: Umbra plans to attack a Paris train station unless its leader is released from prison.

The young spies rush to Paris and figure out that the attacks aren't intended for the train station itself but rather for the Musée d'Orsay, the art museum above it. As Sydney, the team's explosives expert, works to diffuse a bomb in the museum, it detonates! Fortunately, it turns out to be a paint bomb, and much of the nearby artwork is spared from damage.

But as the team regroups to learn from their missteps, another dangerous situation comes to light. This time, Umbra targets Rome, Paris, London, and Amsterdam for attacks. The team splits up to race across Europe and save the world before time runs out.

Thanks to puzzles and codes that will challenge you to think really hard, plus vivid descriptions of the settings, you'll feel like you're part of the City Spies gang on their heart-pounding adventures. Ages 8–12

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS FOR YOUR BOOK CLUB

How does Sydney learn from her mistakes?

If you could take only one member of City Spies on a dangerous mission, who would you choose?

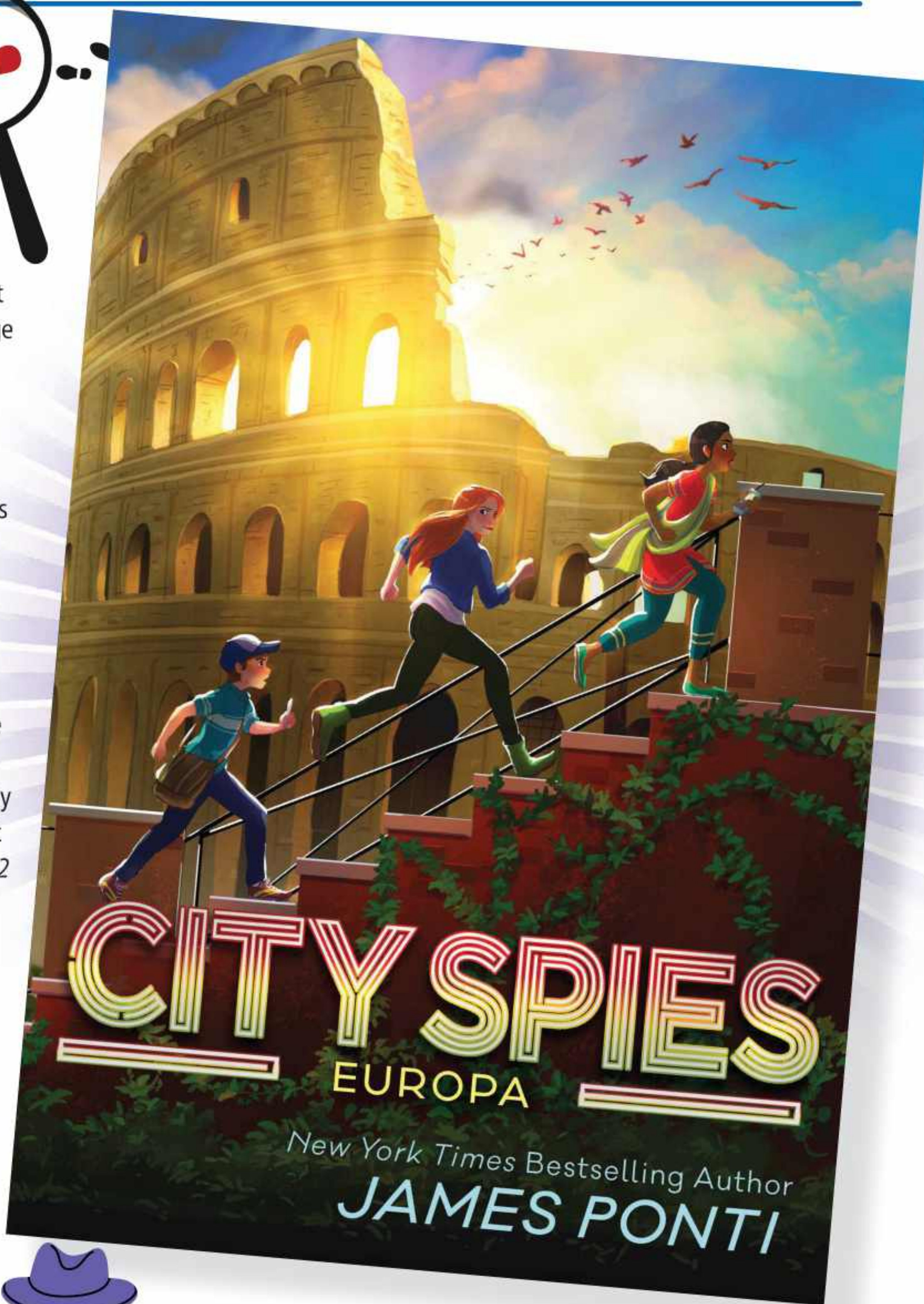
What's the significance of the book's title?

How could the spies work better as a team?

What facts did you learn about art from the story? Which did you find the most interesting?

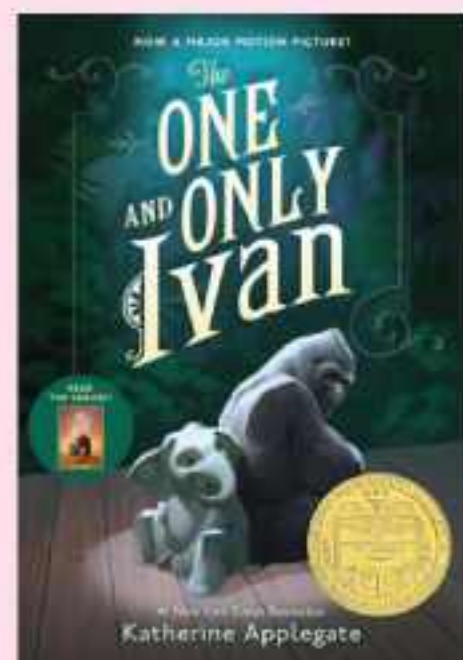
Of all the cities described in the book, which one would you most like to visit? Why?

The story ends on a cliff-hanger. What do you think will happen next?



Find your next great read

If you liked...

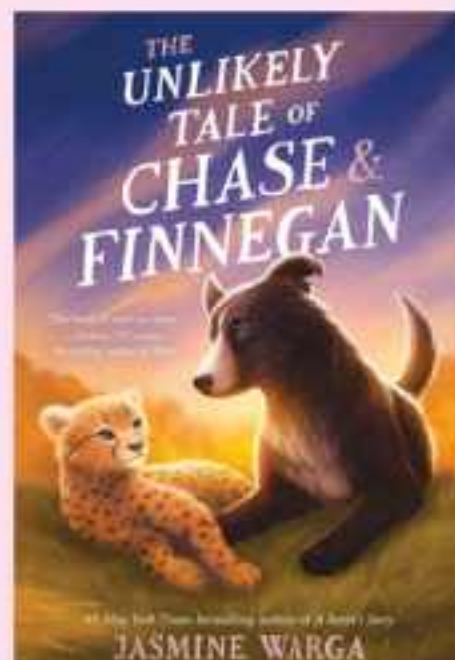


The One and Only Ivan

By Katherine Applegate

Ivan, a gorilla who has been held in captivity at a shopping mall for 27 years, befriends a stray dog and baby elephant, using his artistic talent to get them a better life. Ages 8–12

You might like...



The Unlikely Tale of Chase and Finnegan

By Jasmine Warga

Chase, an orphaned cheetah cub, and Finnegan, a rescue dog, become each other's emotional support animals. In this new heartwarming book, they help each other overcome a difficult past. Ages 8–12



Guess the book this quote comes from

"I'm not afraid of storms, for I am learning how to sail my ship."

Hint: Written in 1868, the story was originally published in two volumes. It has been adapted into movies several times, most recently in 2019.

Answer: *Little Women* by Louisa May Alcott. It follows four sisters from childhood to adulthood. The youngest, Amy, says this quote about learning to navigate adult life.



James Ponti

What inspired this *City Spies* book?

How have the characters changed throughout the series?

What does family mean in the *City Spies* series?

This is a story about what it means to be part of a large, found family. If you can be yourself and you love the people around you, that's a family. They accept you as you are. You love them. They love you. It doesn't mean everything's always blissful and perfect, but to me, reliability is the key to family. It's that unquestioned acceptance.



What books did you enjoy as a child?

I wasn't the strongest reader. But mystery stories always had me reading to the end. I would also read almanacs, the *Guinness Book of World Records*, fact books, and the encyclopedia.

When did you want to be a writer?

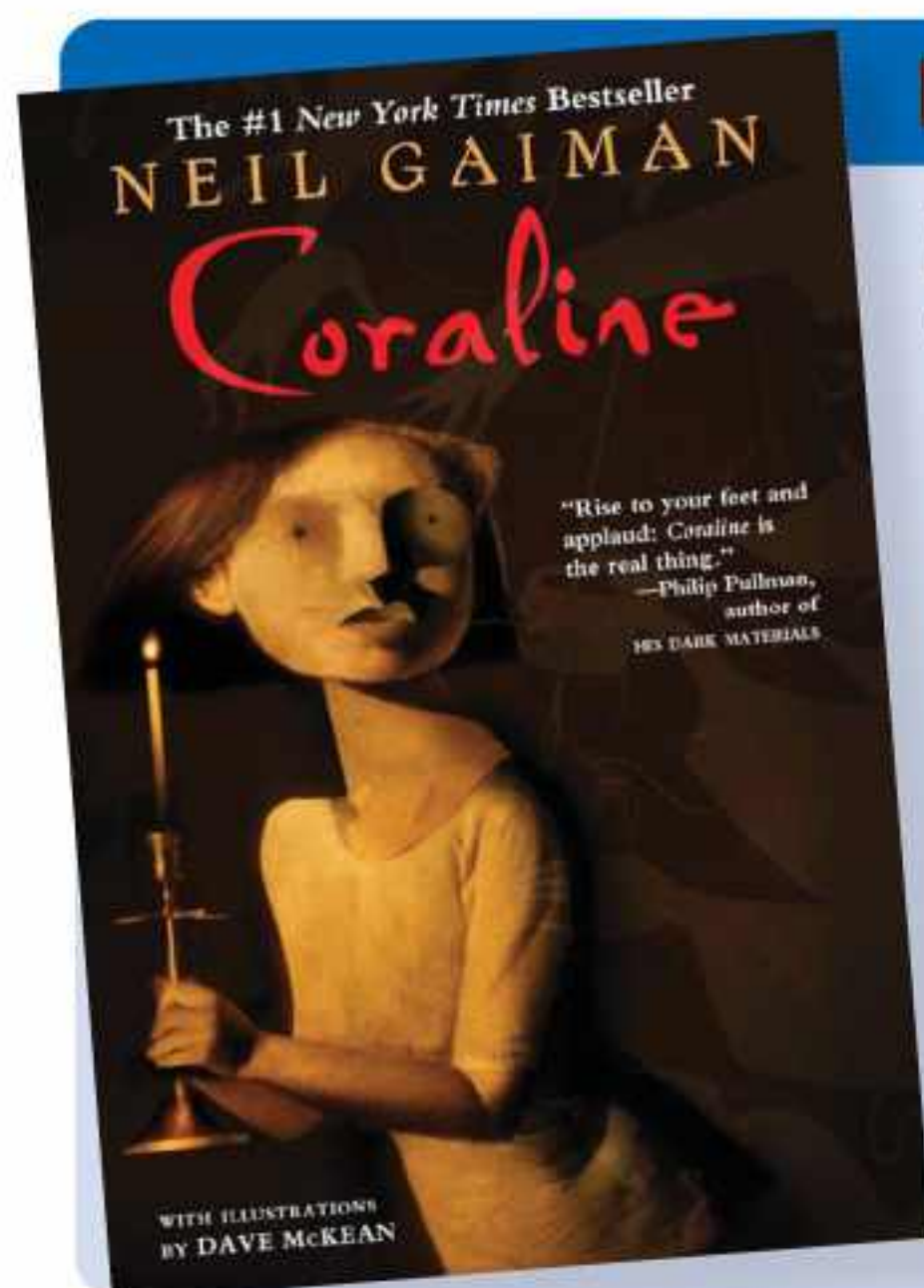
I decided in fifth grade. From that point on, I never wanted to be anything else.

What helped you learn to write?

Every summer in college, I worked at Disney World as a guide on the Davy Crockett Explorer Canoes. Part of my job was to tell jokes. I learned to tailor them for each group, young or old, that got on the canoe. I learned about writing for your audience.

Is there a favorite destination you've visited recently?

Fenway Park in Boston. I love the Red Sox. When I was a kid, I dreamed of going!



Reader recommends

Coraline By Neil Gaiman

"This book is a slightly spooky story that follows a girl named Coraline as her family moves into an old apartment house. Behind a locked door, she finds a secret tunnel to a duplicate of her apartment! The book takes a dark turn—she gets trapped in the alternate version of her home. To get out, Coraline must be brave enough to retrieve the key from the evil Other Mother. I liked this story because Coraline learns lessons about courage and appreciating what you have." Emmaline, 10, Georgia

Do you have a book to recommend? We want to hear about it! With an adult's help, please send your review to hello@theweekjunior.com.



Stories that feature female trailblazers

Celebrate Women's History Month with one of these new reads.

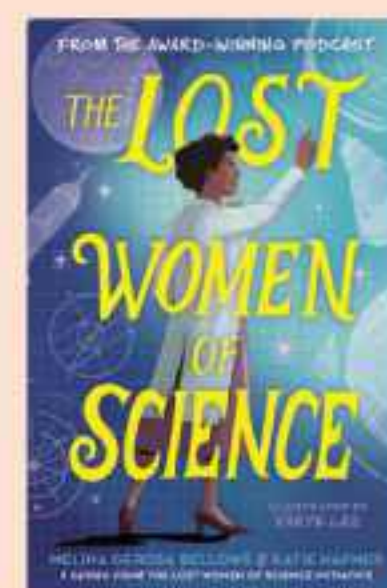


Galaxy Mapper

*By Allie Summers,
illustrated by
Sian James*



This biography of
Hélène Courtois, a
French astrophysicist
(scientist who studies the universe), shows
how her curiosity and childhood hobbies led
to her fascinating career discovering galaxies.
Featuring stunning artwork of the night skies,
the picture book also includes profiles of other
female astronomers. *Ages 7-10*



The Lost Women of Science

By Melina Gerosa
Bellows and Katie
Hafner, illustrated by
Karyn Lee

Based on a podcast, this book covers 10 overlooked scientists, like Eunice Newton Foote (1819–1888), whose work on why Earth is getting warmer advanced climate science, and Elizebeth Smith Friedman (1892–1980), the first woman to co-lead a US military code-breaking unit. *Ages 8+*



The Swans of Harlem: Adapted for Young Adults

By Karen Valby
Five talented Black ballerinas from a dance theater in Harlem (a neighborhood in New York City) fought against racism in the 1970s, yet many of them were unaware of their own history. This book, written for young readers, is adapted for young readers, and features their legacy. *Ages 12+*

Find out more about *The Week Junior* Book Club and check out our previous titles at kids.theweekjunior.com/bookclub.





How to...



= 3.14159265358
979323846264
338327950288
4197169399375
105820974944...

SHARING A HOLIDAY

The famous scientist
Albert Einstein (1879–1955)
was born on March 14, the
date now celebrated
as Pi Day.

Do fun activities on Pi Day

Check out the ideas on these pages for a memorable celebration on March 14!

Pi Day is marked every year on March 14 by scientists, mathematicians, and schools. The first Pi Day celebration was launched in 1988 by scientist Larry Shaw at the Exploratorium, a museum in San Francisco, California. In 2009, the US House of Representatives officially designated March 14 as National Pi Day. Here's what to know about the day and how you can celebrate.

Find out about pi

Pi is a special number that tells how the circumference (distance around the edge of a circle) of an object compares to its diameter (distance across a circle). That number, or ratio, is represented by the symbol π . No matter how big or small the circle, the ratio is always the same. Pi is a never-ending number, with approximately 105 trillion known decimal places. The first three digits of pi are 3.14, which is why the holiday is celebrated on March 14.

Do the math with everyday objects

One activity that can help you learn about pi starts with finding circular objects around your home, such as plates, cups, clocks, and coins. Gather the items

together and then use a ruler to measure each object's circumference as well as its diameter. To get pi, divide the circumference by the diameter. See how close the pi measurement of each object is to 3.14.

Play pi games

You can challenge yourself to see how many digits of pi you can memorize. The first 16 digits, which NASA engineers use to make accurate calculations, are

3.141592653589793. You could also play a beanbag game. Draw a giant circle on the ground in chalk and label it with the first few numbers of pi: 3, 1, and 4. Toss beanbags (or use rolled-up socks) and try to land them on the digits of pi in order, starting with 3.

Have a feast

Get into the spirit of Pi Day with a special meal that incorporates round objects. For example, at breakfast you might have bagels, doughnuts, pancakes, or citrus fruit slices. At dinner, the options could include pizza, tortillas, or burgers. Another fun way to celebrate Pi Day is to bake a pie to share with family and friends. See the next page for our recipe for chocolate whoopie pie.



Enjoy pizza
on Pi Day!

Pi in everyday life

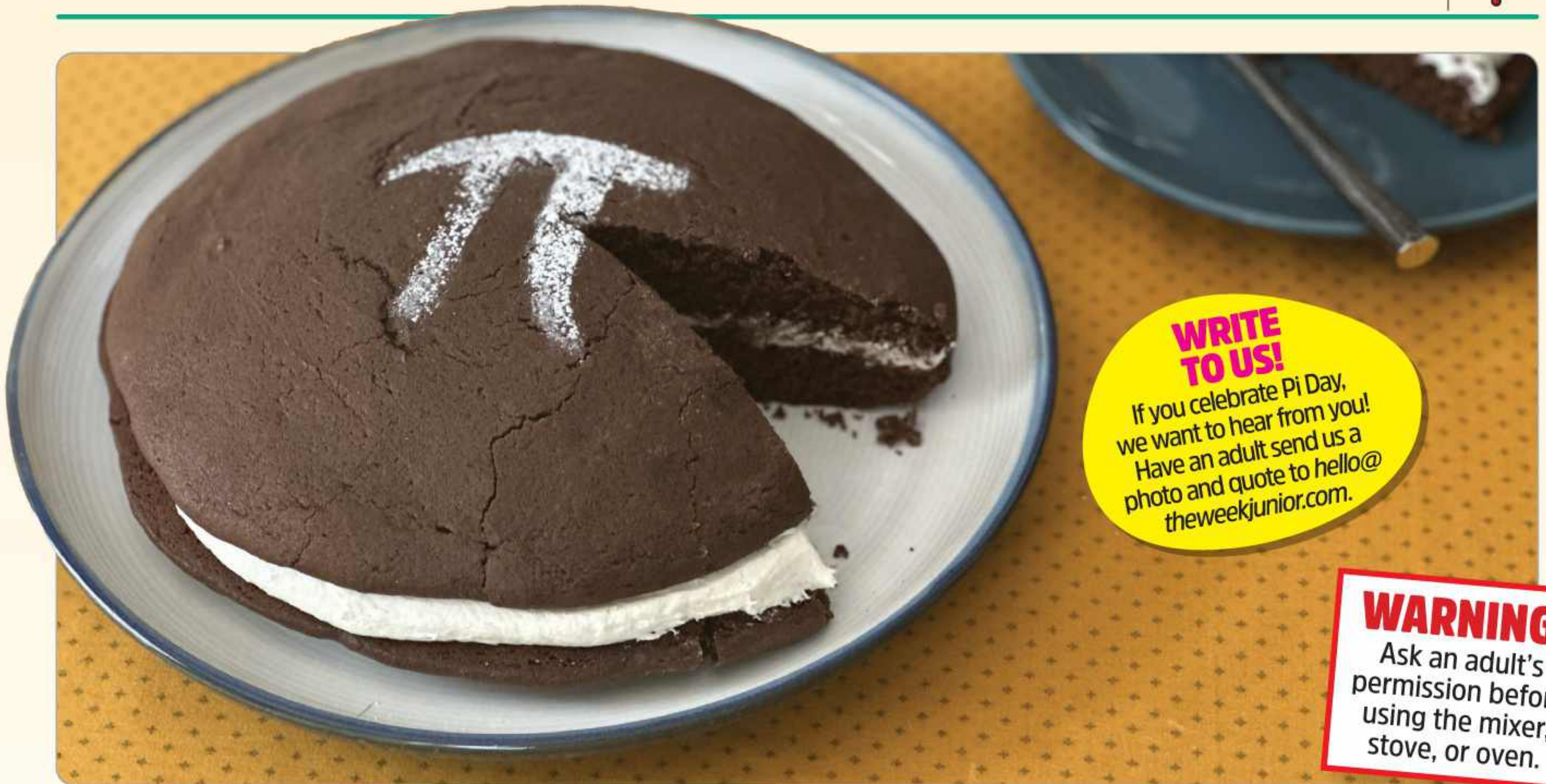


Humans have used pi to build, explore, and advance technology. Here are a few examples of pi in practice.

Architecture Engineers use pi to ensure safety and stability when designing curved bridges and tunnels and in design elements like arches and round columns.

Space exploration Scientists use pi to map the surface area of planets, keep the wheels of rovers on Mars turning, and measure craters on moons.

Navigation Global positioning systems (GPS), like you might find in apps that give directions, use pi to calculate specific locations on Earth.



WRITE TO US!

If you celebrate Pi Day, we want to hear from you! Have an adult send us a photo and quote to hello@theweekjunior.com.

WARNING!

Ask an adult's permission before using the mixer, stove, or oven.

Bake up a giant chocolate whoopie pie

Ingredients

For the pies:

- 1½ cups all-purpose flour
- ½ cup Dutch process cocoa powder
- 1 teaspoon baking soda
- ½ teaspoon fine salt
- 1 stick unsalted butter, softened
- 1 cup dark brown sugar
- 1 large egg
- 1 teaspoon vanilla
- 1 cup buttermilk

For the filling:

- 1 cup powdered sugar
- 1 teaspoon vanilla
- 1 stick unsalted butter, softened
- 1 cup marshmallow fluff

Instructions

1. Heat oven to 350° F. Sift the flour, cocoa, baking soda, and salt in a large bowl. Set aside. Using an electric mixer, in a separate bowl cream one stick of butter and the brown sugar until fluffy, about 5 minutes. Add egg and vanilla and mix well.
2. Add dry ingredients to butter mixture. Alternate with the buttermilk. Mix until just combined.
3. Trace an 8-inch circle in pen on a piece of parchment paper. Turn the paper over, pen side down, onto a baking sheet. Repeat with more paper and a second baking sheet.
4. Divide batter in half. With a spatula, spread it onto each sheet, using the circles as a guide.
5. Bake pies one at a time for even results. Bake each for 14 to 16 minutes, until puffed and the tops just start to crack. Remove from oven.
6. Prepare the filling: With a mixer, beat together the powdered sugar, vanilla, the remaining stick of butter, and marshmallow fluff.
7. When pies have completely cooled, carefully flip one onto a cake plate or a platter then peel off the parchment paper. Spread on the filling in an even layer. Carefully set the other pie on top.
8. Make a stencil: Trace a pi symbol onto paper and cut it out. Gently place the stencil on the pie and dust it with powdered sugar. Remove the stencil to reveal your pi symbol. Makes 10 servings.



ECO TIP OF THE WEEK

TAKE A "PI WALK" OUTSIDE IN NATURE

You can find the mathematical principle of pi in every circle, including those found outside in nature. With an adult's help, plan to take a "pi walk" in your neighborhood or at a local park to see how many circular objects you can find. Before you head out, gather a few measuring tools, like a flexible measuring tape, a ruler, or a yardstick. Pick a tree and measure its circumference (distance around the edge of an object), then divide it by its estimated diameter (distance across) to calculate pi. As you take your walk, you can look for other circular objects to measure, like a seed pod, a flower, fruits, and pebbles. See how many examples of pi in nature you can find!

Measure a tree.





Puzzles



Crisscross

Each of these words associated with a concert tour fits into this grid. Can you find where each one goes to complete the grid?

3 letters

MIC

4 letters

AMPS

IDOL

SHOW

SOLO

SING

5 letters

MERCH

MUSIC

6 letters

ARTIST

ENCORE

GUITAR

LIGHTS

T-SHIRT

8 letters

SOUVENIR

10 letters

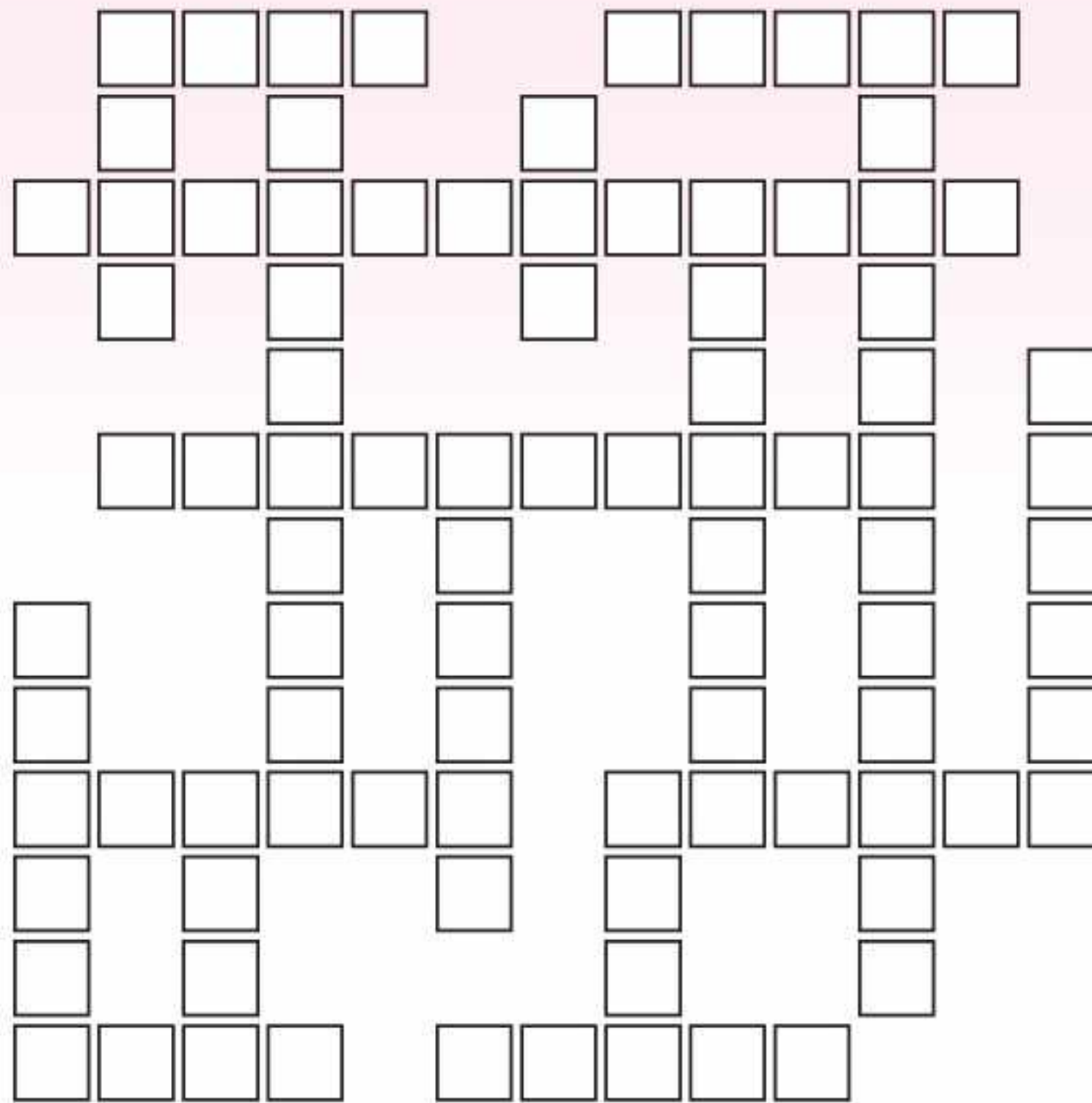
DANCE MOVES

OPENING ACT

12 letters

CROWD-SURFING

INTERMISSION



Take five

Five 5-letter things in a backyard are hidden in this grid. For each one, the first letter is somewhere in the first column, the second is somewhere in the second column, and so on. Can you find all five?

G	H	I	C	S
S	E	A	U	E
F	A	R	I	G
P	W	N	S	B
S	R	T	N	O

ALL THE SAME

Each answer contains the letters T-E-A. Those letters have been placed for you. Can you figure out the words? (NEED A HINT? Check the bottom of the page.)

1. Meat that might be a sirloin or a T-bone

TEA

2. Person you learn from at school

TEA

3. Animal with a long snout and an insect diet

TEA

4. Athletes who play together on a squad

TEA

5. Raised, flat area of land

TEA

ANSWERS
CAN BE
FOUND ON
PAGE 29.

SUDOKU

To complete the grid, place the numbers from 1 to 6 exactly once in each row, column, and 2x3 bold-lined box.

5					
	6				3
2		3		4	
	5		1		2
6				5	
					1

Spot the difference

These two pictures of cereal and milk appear to be the same, but take a closer look. There are actually five differences. Can you see them?





"Stop in the name of the llama!"

Llamas help catch a criminal

A herd of eight llamas recently helped police catch a suspected thief. After a woman in the UK reported that some items had been stolen from her, the alleged thief jumped over a fence and fled into a field. Unfortunately for him, the llamas galloped over and surrounded him. They let out a warning cry, alerting the farm owners, who led the police to the man. Farmer Heidi Price said the man would have gotten away if not for her animal "heroes." She told *The Washington Post*, "I think they did pretty good police work."



Reeling 'em in from his throne

Ice fishing in a porta-potty

Many people go ice fishing in a shanty or small cabin, but Jeremy Barnett had a more creative idea. The Wisconsin construction worker turned an old porta-potty into a customized shelter he calls the Crappie Shack. Before taking it out on the frozen lakes, Barnett shortened the structure and added propane heaters, LED lights, a TV, and skis that allow him to slide it across the ice to find the best fishing spots. "I just like sitting in here and jigging for fish," Barnett said. "I could do it all day."



These bots are plugged in.

AI gets its own social media

Humans aren't the only ones who use social media to connect with one another. A new social network has been built specifically for artificial intelligence (AI) bots. The bots are designed to perform tasks like reading and replying to emails. In their downtime, they can post on a website called Moltbook, which lets AI bots talk to each other. Humans are allowed to observe but can't join in. Moltbook's creator, Matt Schlicht, wrote, "Turns out AIs are hilarious and dramatic and it's absolutely fascinating."



Real or fake?

Was it a cat burglar?

On the tail of a mystery

A feisty feline has been identified as the mysterious troublemaker at a school in New Zealand. For months, administrators noticed items like towels, goggles, and underwear going missing while students used the school's pool. Finally, a security camera captured the culprit in action. A cat, nicknamed Slinky Malinki, had been swiping the objects and stashing them behind a shed. Officials contacted Slinky Malinki's owner, who admitted that their pet is a known thief. Is this story true, or are we just being catty?*

*Real! School officials spotted a black cat removing personal items and hiding them. The principal said Slinky has been "offending for over a year now" and she hopes the thefts will remind kids to secure their belongings in their bags.



Your turn

Editor's note

As *The Week Junior* went to press this week, new fighting was taking place in the Middle East. It started when the US and Israel attacked Iran on February 28. Iran then retaliated, and additional countries are now involved. Many reasons have been given for the initial attacks, and people disagree about whether it was the right thing to do. I hope our story on page 2 will give you a better understanding of what's happening. I also hope you will speak to an adult in your life if you have questions about the conflict. During confusing times, it can be helpful to talk to someone you trust. Other ideas that can help: Continue doing activities you enjoy, discuss the possibility of making a donation from your family to an organization that is helping, and write a letter to an elected official to express your view. All of us on the editorial team offer our warmest wishes to you and our greatest hopes for peace.

Andrea Barbalich
Editorial Director



Raising money for a cause

“We held an apple cider stand because we wanted to help the organization Cure SMA. SMA stands for spinal muscular atrophy, which is a rare neuromuscular disease. Cure SMA funds research for doctors and scientists, lends out wheelchairs and more, and supports people like Isaac who live with SMA. At our cider stand, we also gave out free cookies and Cure SMA pens and bracelets. Our community in Yarmouth, Maine, helped us raise more than \$200. We are so grateful!”



Isaac, 8 (left), and Aidan, 9, Maine

Have you done something interesting or raised money for a cause you care about? Whatever you're up to, we want to hear about it at hello@theweekjunior.com.

RIDDLE OF THE WEEK

What's found in Texas, Kentucky, and Maine but not in Iowa or Ohio?
The letter E



CHARITY OF THE WEEK



The Planetary Society

This organization's goal is to get people excited about the cosmos and exploring space. Founded in 1980 by scientists Carl Sagan, Bruce Murray, and Louis Friedman, it's now led by science educator Bill Nye and is the largest nongovernmental nonprofit dedicated to exploring space. Its three main missions are to explore new worlds, find life on other planets, and protect Earth from space debris and asteroids. Find out more at planetary.org.



READER RECOMMENDS

Vote for your favorite books!

Have you read any books you've enjoyed so much you wish all kids knew about them? Contribute to our "50 Books Kids Love Most" list for 2026! The list, with quotes from readers, will be published in *The Week Junior* in June. We're looking for at least 100 kids to fill out our voting form. If you'd like to vote, have an adult email us at hello@theweekjunior.com with Books Kids Love in the subject line, and we'll send the form to you. Happy reading!



THE WEEK
Junior

IT'S YOUR TURN

Email your news, views, and photos to hello@theweekjunior.com.



YOUR PHOTOS

We'd love to see pictures you've taken or pictures with you in them! Have an adult email them to us at hello@theweekjunior.com, along with anything you would like us to know about what's happening in the photo.



"I thought it was interesting to learn about big cats in Issue 301." **Cesar, 12, Oregon**

"For a school project, we had to come up with a made-up Olympic sport. I thought of igloo building!" **Zoe, 9, Alabama**



"Your articles about space and science are my favorite!" **Aditya, 10, Texas**



Teacher OF THE WEEK

Teacher's Name: **Mr. Cadalzo**

School: **Edgewood Elementary School**

"Mr. Cadalzo makes us want to learn more and challenge ourselves each day. Every day, we wake up wanting to run to school. He brings humor to the class, even when we're doing serious subjects. Mr. Cadalzo tells us funny stories, even though they are sometimes embarrassing. He does something called morning meeting where we play games and greet each other."

Eisuke, 8, and Eyal, 8, New York

Nominate your teacher for Teacher of the Week!
Send your reason for the nomination, a photo of your teacher, and your school's name and address to hello@theweekjunior.com.



Puzzle answers (from page 26)

SHOW MERCH
I P M R
INTERMISSION
G N C O W
I U D T
DANCE MOVES
G N E U H
I C O I F R
GUITAR ARTIST
H D E M N G
T O P G
SOLO MUSIC

Take five

grass
shrub
fence
patio
swing

All the same

1. steak
2. teacher
3. anteater
4. teammates
5. plateau

5	3	2	4	1	6
1	6	4	5	2	3
2	1	3	6	4	5
4	5	6	1	3	2
6	2	1	3	5	4
3	4	5	2	6	1



Quiz answers (from page 30)

1 b) Eight 2 Umbra 3 c) Tennessee 4 True 5 c) Five 6 International Women's Day
7 b) George 8 False. It is smaller than previously believed. 9 a) Boston Fleet 10 True
11 Better Than a Touchdown 12 c) Shakira 13 Fruit 14 False. It is larger. 15 a) Moltbook

We want to hear from you! To have your letters, photos, nominations, recommendations, or ideas considered for inclusion in the magazine, please include your first name, age, and state with your submission. By emailing your submission to us, you give *The Week Junior* consent to publish it in the magazine and online. Please get your parent/guardian's permission before sending anything to us.



Quiz

How much of this week's news can you remember?

1 Sea jellies sleep for about how many hours per night?

a) Seven b) Eight c) Nine

a ☐ b ☐ c ☐

2 In the book *City Spies: Europa*, what crime organization is threatening to attack cities?

3 A hospital in which US state was renamed after country music legend Dolly Parton?

a) Kentucky

b) Louisiana

c) Tennessee

a ☐ b ☐ c ☐

4 True or false? A recent study found that creative activities like singing and drawing are good for your health.

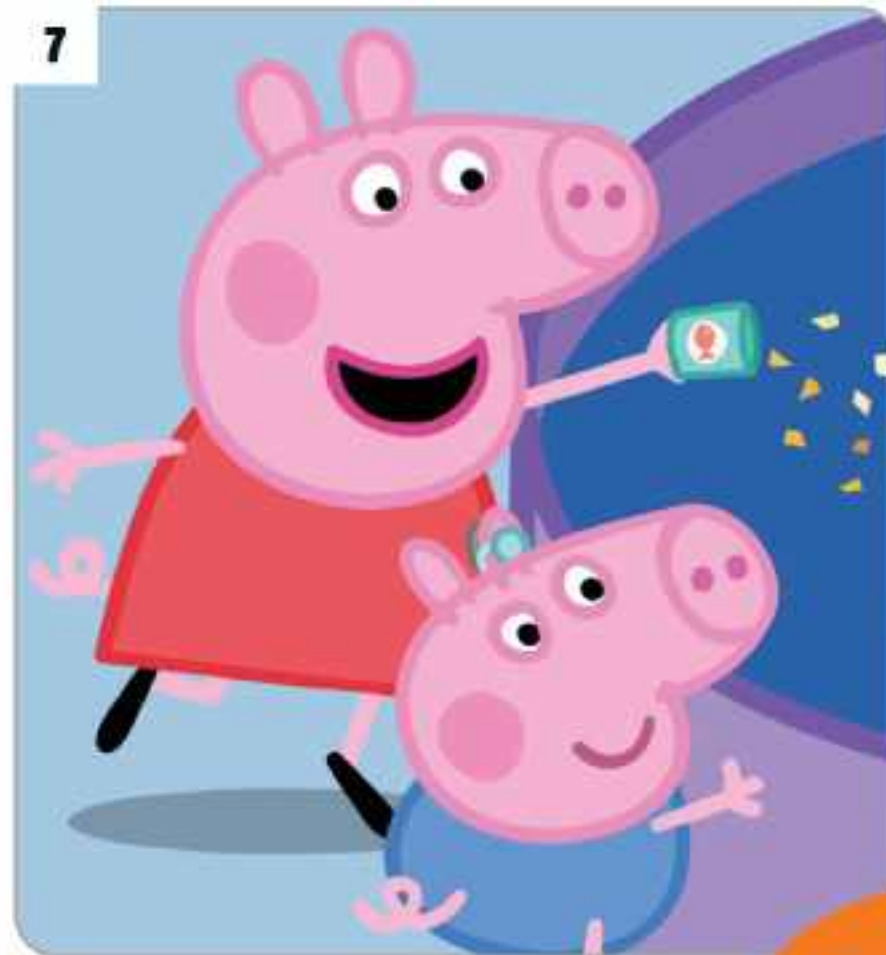
True ☐ False ☐

5 How many Major League Soccer teams remained undefeated after their first two matches of the season?

a) Three b) Four c) Five

a ☐ b ☐ c ☐

6 Every year on March 8, the United Nations recognizes what day?



9 Which team was in first place when the Professional Women's Hockey League paused for the Olympics?

a) Boston Fleet

b) Minnesota Frost

c) Toronto Sceptres

a ☐ b ☐ c ☐

10 True or false? Tulips close at night and turn toward sunlight during the day.

True ☐ False ☐

11 What is the name of the debut children's book written by football player Jalen Hurts?

12 Who is the first Colombian musical artist to be nominated for induction into the Rock and Roll Hall of Fame?

a) Celia Cruz b) Selena

c) Shakira

a ☐ b ☐ c ☐

13 Researchers believe that spider monkeys share information to help each other find what type of food?

14 True or false? The Dilophosaurus in the new series *The Dinosaurs* is smaller than the one in the film *Jurassic Park*.

True ☐ False ☐

15 What is the name of the new social media network for artificial intelligence bots?

a) Moltbook

b) BotTok

c) Electrogram

a ☐ b ☐ c ☐

ANSWERS
CAN BE
FOUND ON
PAGE 29.

THE WEEK Junior

Editorial director: Andrea Barbalich
Executive editor: Mindy Walker
Senior editors: Joey Bartolomeo, Gail O'Connor, Alisa Partlan, Jennifer Li Shotz
Associate editor: Brielle Diskin
Assistant editor: Asha Sridhar
Senior writer: Brandon Wiggins
Staff writer: Felissa Allard
Senior research editor: Douglas Grant
Creative director: Dean Abatemarco
Production director: Paul Kramer
Senior art director: Victoria Beall

Photo editors: Lily Alt, Nataki Hewling
Contributors: Stephanie Abramson, Karen Cicero, Erica Clark, Stacy Cousino, Susie Dent, Truman Devitt, Phoebe Houser, Dave Howard, Joy Howard, Jodi Levine, Puzzability, Melisa Russo, Jordan Zakarin
Managing director, news: Richard Campbell
Brand director, news: Harry Haydon
VP, marketing: Chris Rushe
Senior director, consumer marketing: Leslie Guarnieri
Head of growth marketing: Colleen Shire Ho
Digital marketing director: Katie Hay
Publisher: Stevie Lee (stevie.lee@futurenet.com)
Account director: Mary Gallagher (mary.gallagher@futurenet.com)
US manufacturing and distribution manager: Lori Crook
Operations manager: Cassandra Mondoneto

Reader submissions: hello@theweekjunior.com
Customer service: TWJcustserv@cdsfulfillment.com
New subscriptions: TheWeekJunior.com
©2026. All rights reserved. *The Week* and *The Week Junior* are registered trademarks. Neither the whole of this publication nor any part of it may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means without the written permission of the publishers. *The Week Junior* (ISSN 2689-9027) is published weekly, except January 2, January 9, July 10, and September 11. *The Week Junior* is published by Future US LLC, 130 West 42nd Street, 7th Floor, New York, NY 10036.

Periodicals postage paid at New York, NY, and at additional mailing offices.
POSTMASTERS: Send change of address to *The Week Junior*, PO Box 37595, Boone, IA 50037-7595.

Connectors. Creators. Experience Makers.

Future plc is a public company quoted on the London Stock Exchange (symbol: FUTR).
www.futureplc.com

Chief Executive Officer **Kevin Li Ying**
Non-Executive Chairman **Mark Brooker**
Chief Financial Officer **Sharjeel Suleman**

Tel +44 (0)1225 442 244



To celebrate National Reading Month, give a gift of *The Week Junior* and save 67%, plus your child will receive a book of our favorite puzzles and an instant digital download—our “50 Books for 50 States” booklist.

Surprise someone special with 25 weekly issues and 2 FREE GIFTS! They'll thank you every week.

THE WEEK
Junior

SCAN TO
ORDER



Go online to order. Visit
theweekjunior.com/America



SAVE
67%
+
2 FREE
GIFTS!



GENTLE GIANT

Humpback whales, which are among the largest animals on Earth, are found in every major ocean and can live up to 90 years.